



■ MissingCrypto by MissingCash

THE COMPLETE AUSTRALIAN CRYPTO RECOVERY GUIDE

Step-by-step guide to recovering lost cryptocurrency wallets, exchange accounts, forgotten passwords and locked assets across all major Australian platforms.

\$100B+ Lost Globally	3.7M+ Aussie Holders	6 Platforms All Covered
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How Crypto Gets Lost in Australia

Over 3.7 million Australians own or have owned cryptocurrency. A significant portion have lost access — not because the crypto is gone, but because access has been lost. Unlike a bank, there is no central authority to call. But there are legitimate steps to recover your assets.

Where Does Crypto Go Missing?

Forgotten password	Exchange account password forgotten, email inaccessible, or 2FA device lost
Old email address	The email used to create the account no longer exists or is inaccessible
Lost 2FA device	Phone was lost, stolen or replaced without backing up 2FA codes
Exchange closed	The platform shut down or was acquired by another company
Hardware wallet	Physical device lost or damaged — but seed phrase may still work
Lost seed phrase	The 12 or 24 word recovery phrase was lost, damaged or forgotten
Deceased estate	A family member passed away holding crypto with no access instructions
Old computer	Wallet software on an old hard drive — may still be recoverable

■ *Tip: Crypto held on an exchange is NOT lost forever just because you lost access. Exchanges have identity verification processes specifically designed to restore access to legitimate account owners.*



Before You Start — What You Need

Before contacting any exchange, gather as much of the following as possible. The more you can provide, the faster your recovery will be.

Documents You May Need

- ✓ Australian driver's licence or passport (photo ID)
- ✓ Medicare card
- ✓ Proof of address — utility bill or bank statement (less than 3 months old)
- ✓ The email address used to create the account
- ✓ Approximate date the account was created
- ✓ Any previous transaction IDs or deposit/withdrawal records
- ✓ Bank account used to deposit funds into the exchange

What To Do First

- 1 Check all your email addresses**
Search every inbox for the exchange name — find which email was used to register
- 2 Try password reset**
Use "Forgot Password" on the exchange — if you have email access this is the fastest fix
- 3 Check your password manager**
Look in LastPass, 1Password, Bitwarden, or your browser saved passwords
- 4 Check old phones**
Old devices may still have the authenticator app with active 2FA codes
- 5 Contact exchange support**
If all else fails, submit a formal ID verification request to the exchange

■■ SCAM WARNING: Never pay anyone upfront to recover your crypto. Legitimate exchanges NEVER charge for account recovery. Any "recovery service" asking for crypto upfront is a scam. See Chapter 11.



CoinSpot Recovery — Australia's #1 Exchange

CoinSpot is Australia's largest cryptocurrency exchange with over 2.5 million users. They have a dedicated support team for account recovery and identity verification.

Step-by-Step CoinSpot Recovery

- 1

Try password reset first
Go to coinspot.com.au → "Forgot Password" → enter your email → check inbox for reset link
- 2

Lost access to email?
Go to coinspot.com.au/support → Submit a ticket → "Account Access" → "I can't access my email"
- 3

Lost 2FA device?
Support → "2FA Issues" → Provide photo ID + selfie holding ID + proof of account ownership
- 4

Submit ID verification
CoinSpot will request: passport or licence + selfie + proof of address + last known transaction details
- 5

Wait for review
CoinSpot typically responds within 1-3 business days. Follow up if no response after 5 days.
- 6

Account restored
Once verified, CoinSpot resets your access. You'll set a new password and 2FA.

CoinSpot Contact Details

Method	Details
Support Portal	coinspot.com.au/support
Email	support@coinspot.com.au
Live Chat	Available on website during business hours (AEST)
Response Time	1-3 business days for ID verification requests

■ *Tip: When submitting ID verification, include your approximate account balance and the date you last accessed the account — this speeds up the process significantly.*



Binance Account Recovery

Binance is the world's largest crypto exchange and is widely used by Australians. Their account recovery process is highly automated but very thorough.

Step-by-Step Binance Recovery

1 Go to Binance.com

Click "Log In" → "Forgot Password?" — try this first even if you think your email is gone

2 Security verification issues

Can't pass security check? Click "Security verification unavailable?" at the bottom of the login page

3 Account recovery form

Binance has a dedicated recovery form — verify identity with ID documents + facial recognition

4 Facial recognition scan

Binance uses automated facial recognition — have your passport or driver's licence ready

5 Submit account details

Provide: email used, registration date, deposit history, linked bank account or card details

6 Wait 1-7 days

Binance's security team reviews manually. Complex cases can take up to 7 business days.

7 New device setup

Once approved, Binance guides you through setting up new 2FA and a new password

■ *Tip: If facial recognition fails, submit a support ticket with manual ID. Include a handwritten note with your name, date and "For Binance Identity Verification" in your selfie photo.*

Binance Contact: support.binance.com — Select "Account" → "Account Recovery"



Coinbase Account Recovery

Coinbase is a US-based exchange used by many Australians, especially early crypto adopters from 2013-2018. They have a robust identity recovery process.

Step-by-Step Coinbase Recovery

- 1 Try account kit**
Go to coinbase.com → "I forgot my password" → Or use coinbase.com/recovery
- 2 Lost phone or 2FA**
On login page, select "I no longer have access to this phone number" — follow the alternatives
- 3 Contact support**
Go to help.coinbase.com → Submit a request → "I can't access my account"
- 4 ID verification**
Coinbase requires: government photo ID + selfie + proof of address + account activity details
- 5 Escalate if needed**
If first request is rejected, reply and ask for escalation to the Account Security team
- 6 Allow 3-10 days**
Coinbase support can be slow. Follow up every 3 days if you haven't heard back.

■ *Tip: Be persistent — many users report success after their 2nd or 3rd follow-up. Keep all ticket numbers and email correspondence.*



Swyftx Recovery — Australian Exchange

Swyftx is one of Australia's fastest-growing crypto exchanges, headquartered in Brisbane. Known for strong local customer support.

Step-by-Step Swyftx Recovery

- 1 Password reset**
Go to swyftx.com → Login → "Forgot your password?" → Check email for reset link
- 2 2FA issues**
Click "Having trouble?" on the login page → Select your issue → Follow guided recovery flow
- 3 Live chat support**
Swyftx has live chat on their website — fastest way to start account recovery
- 4 Submit ID documents**
Swyftx will request: driver's licence or passport + selfie + proof of address + account details
- 5 Email support**
Email support@swyftx.com — Subject: "Account Recovery Request" — include all details upfront
- 6 Response time**
Swyftx typically responds within 24-48 hours — faster than most exchanges

Swyftx Contact: support@swyftx.com · swyftx.com/support · Live chat available on website



Independent Reserve Recovery

Independent Reserve is a premium Australian exchange founded in 2013, used by high-value investors. They offer dedicated phone support — rare among exchanges.

Step-by-Step Recovery

Password reset

- 1 Go to independentreserve.com → Login → "Forgot password" → Reset via your registered email

2FA recovery

- 2 Email support@independentreserve.com — Subject: "2FA Recovery Request" — handled manually

Phone support

- 3 Call 1300 550 954 (Australia) during AEST business hours — fastest resolution method

Identity verification

- 4 They require: passport or driver's licence + proof of address + account history details

High-value accounts

- 5 For accounts over \$10,000, request a senior account manager — significantly faster resolution

Independent Reserve Contact: support@independentreserve.com · Phone: 1300 550 954



Hardware Wallet & Seed Phrase Recovery

Hardware wallets (Ledger, Trezor) store crypto offline. If you lose the device but have your seed phrase, your crypto is fully recoverable on any new device.

Scenario 1 — Lost Device, Have Seed Phrase (Best Case)

Your 12 or 24 word seed phrase is all you need to recover everything.

- ✓ Buy a new Ledger or Trezor (or use any compatible wallet)
- ✓ During setup, select "Restore from recovery phrase"
- ✓ Enter your 12 or 24 words in the exact order — your entire wallet restores
- ✓ All coins across all addresses are automatically recovered
- ✓ Set a new PIN on your new device

Scenario 2 — Have Device, Forgot PIN

- Ledger: After 3 wrong PIN attempts, device resets — restore using your seed phrase
- Trezor: Use "Wipe device" in Trezor Suite, then restore using seed phrase
- No seed phrase = the crypto on that device may be permanently inaccessible

Scenario 3 — Old Computer Wallet (Bitcoin Core etc)

- Look for a file called "wallet.dat" on the old computer or hard drive
- Copy this file somewhere safe — it contains your private keys
- Install the same wallet software and import the wallet.dat file
- If encrypted, you need the original passphrase to unlock it
- Professional data recovery services can sometimes recover files from damaged drives

■ *Tip: NEVER enter your seed phrase on any website or share it with anyone. Your seed phrase gives complete control of your wallet. Any site asking for it is a scam.*

■ **Only have part of your seed phrase (e.g. 11 of 12 words)? Free software "btcrecover" on GitHub can sometimes find the missing word.**



If The Exchange Has Closed Down

Some exchanges have shut down, been hacked or gone into administration. Your options depend on how and why they closed.

Known Closed Australian Exchanges

Exchange	Status	What To Do
Cryptopia	Hacked 2019 / liquidation	File a claim: cryptopia.co.nz/claims
ACX (AU Crypto Exchange)	Closed 2019	Contact ASIC if funds unrecovered
Bit Trade	Acquired by Kraken	Log in via Kraken.com with old credentials
Other closed exchanges	Varies	Contact ASIC or AFCA to lodge a complaint

Steps If Your Exchange Has Closed

- Search "[Exchange name] liquidation claim" — most have a formal claims process
- Contact ASIC at asic.gov.au — they oversee Australian financial services
- Contact AFCA at afca.org.au or call 1800 931 678
- Check if the exchange was acquired — your account may have been transferred to the new owner
- Search the ASIC insolvency register:
asic.gov.au/online-services/insolvency-register



ATO & Tax Implications of Recovered Crypto

The ATO treats cryptocurrency as a capital gains tax (CGT) asset. Recovering access is NOT a taxable event — but selling, trading or using it may be.

Key ATO Rules for Crypto

Recovering access	NOT a taxable event — you are simply regaining access to what you already own
Selling crypto	CGT applies — the gain is the difference between purchase price and sale price in AUD
Trading crypto	Each crypto-to-crypto trade is also a taxable event — not just selling for AUD
Lost crypto	If genuinely permanently lost (not just inaccessible), you may be able to claim a capital loss
Record keeping	Keep records of all transactions — dates, amounts and AUD values at time of each transaction
12 month discount	Held crypto for over 12 months before selling? You may qualify for a 50% CGT discount

■ *Tip: Tools like Koinly, CryptoTaxCalculator and CoinTracker automatically import transaction history and calculate capital gains for your ATO tax return.*

ATO crypto guide:

ato.gov.au/individuals-and-families/investments-and-assets/crypto-asset-investments



Scam Warning — Protect Yourself

Crypto recovery scams are extremely common. Criminals specifically target people who have lost access to their crypto, promising recovery services that are completely fraudulent.

Warning Signs of a Crypto Recovery Scam



Upfront payment required

Legitimate exchanges NEVER charge to recover your account. Any upfront fee is a scam.



Asks for seed phrase

NEVER give your seed phrase to anyone — ever. They will steal everything immediately.



Guarantees recovery

No one can guarantee crypto recovery. Anyone who does is lying to you.



They contact you first

Scammers reach out via social media, Telegram or email claiming they can recover your funds.



Fake exchange websites

Always type exchange URLs directly — never click links in emails or messages.



Remote access requests

Never give anyone remote access to your device for "recovery" purposes.

If You've Been Scammed

- Report to Scamwatch: scamwatch.gov.au or call 1300 795 995
- Report to Australian Cyber Security Centre: cyber.gov.au/report
- Contact your bank immediately if you sent money
- Report to local police — get a report number for insurance purposes



Your Crypto Asset Tracker

Record all your crypto accounts and recovery status. Store this document securely. Do NOT record seed phrases here — ever.

Exchange / Wallet	Email Used	Status	Action Taken

Recovery Checklist

☐	Tried password reset on all exchanges
☐	Searched all email inboxes for exchange registration emails
☐	Checked password manager for saved credentials
☐	Checked old phones for 2FA authenticator apps
☐	Submitted formal ID verification request to each exchange



Checked for seed phrase backup (12 or 24 word list)



Searched old computers for wallet.dat files



Checked if any exchanges have been acquired or closed



Reported any scam attempts to Scamwatch



Consulted a tax agent about recovered crypto obligations



Good luck — go find your crypto! ■

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